

Lab 03

Canva as a design tool

Objective:

To familiarize students with basic design skills required for websites and marketing purposes using a design tool that can cover all the different aspects related to ecommerce presence and marketing. The design tool, Canva, makes designing easy for everyone and for any purpose from social media images, videos and gifs to posters, websites, booklets, multimedia presentations, and more.

Activity Outcomes:

After this lab, the students should be able:

- To brainstorm ideas for designing different sections of there website or ads/posts related to marketing.
- To effectively transform ideas into publishable designs e.g. flyers, posters, infographics, posts, etc.

Instructor Note:

As pre-lab activity, read Canva comprehensive design school tutorials, articles, and video courses on various design topics available on Design School homepage (<https://www.canva.com/designschool/>)

Useful Concepts:

Design tools

Graphic design tools are software applications used to create visual content. They can be used for a variety of purposes, such as creating logos, illustrations, marketing materials, and web graphics.

There are many different graphic design tools available, each with its own strengths and weaknesses. Some of the most popular tools include:

- **Adobe Photoshop** is the industry standard for photo editing and manipulation. It offers a wide range of tools for editing photos, creating graphics, and working with text.
- **Adobe Illustrator** is a vector graphics editor that can be used to create logos, illustrations, and icons. Vector graphics are made up of lines and shapes, which can be scaled infinitely without losing quality.
- **InDesign** is a page layout program that is used to create magazines, brochures, and other multi-page documents.
- **Canva** is a web-based graphic design tool that is easy to use for beginners. It offers a wide range of templates and tools for creating social media graphics, presentations, and other marketing materials.
- **GIMP** is a free and open-source image editor that offers many of the same features as Photoshop.

The best graphic design tool for you will depend on your needs and experience level. If you are a beginner, you may want to start with a user-friendly tool like Canva. If you are a professional designer, you may need a more powerful tool like Photoshop or Illustrator.

Canva

Canva is an online graphic design tool used to create social media graphics, presentations, posters, documents, and other visual content, including videos. As opposed to other graphic design tools that require some level of expertise, Canva is specifically laid out for ease of use, which means novice users can feel more comfortable starting out with the tool. Canva offers a large number of pre-built templates so that digital marketers can create on-brand posts at an expert design level. Here are some key points about Canva:

- **Focus:** Creating social media graphics, presentations, posters, flyers, and other basic visual content.
- **Strengths:**
 - **User-friendly:** Drag-and-drop interface with pre-made templates, fonts, and stock photos makes it perfect for beginners.
 - **Variety:** Offers a vast library of templates and design elements to jump-start your creations.
 - **Collaboration:** Allows team collaboration on designs.
 - **Affordability:** Provides a free plan with paid options for access to more features and assets.
- **Weaknesses:**
 - **Limited editing capabilities:** Compared to professional design software like Photoshop, it offers less flexibility for in-depth editing.
 - **Template-driven:** While offering a great starting point, heavy reliance on templates can limit creative freedom for complex designs.

Canva's interface is designed to be user-friendly, especially for those new to graphic design. Here's a breakdown of the key areas:

Workspace:

- This is the central area where you create your designs. You can choose from pre-sized templates or custom dimensions to get started.

Templates:

- Canva offers a vast library of templates for various purposes like social media posts, presentations, posters, flyers, and more. These templates provide a great starting point with pre-designed layouts and elements.

Design Elements:

- On the left side of the workspace, you'll find a panel with various design elements. This includes:
 - **Photos:** Millions of free and premium stock photos are categorized for easy browsing. (Free plan offers limited selection).
 - **Graphics:** A collection of icons, illustrations, shapes, and lines to add visual interest to your designs.
 - **Text:** Choose from a variety of fonts and customize text styles like color, size, and weight.

Editing Tools:

- At the top of the workspace, you'll find basic editing tools for:
 - Arranging elements:** Drag and drop to position and layer elements on your design.
 - Resizing and cropping:** Easily resize or crop photos and graphics.
 - Text editing:** Change fonts, size, color, and alignment of your text.
 - Backgrounds:** Choose from solid colors, gradients, or image backgrounds.

Other Features:

- Navigation bar:** Located at the top, it provides access to your projects, templates, uploads, and brand kit (Canva Pro only).
- Search bar:** Search for specific design elements or templates.
- Sharing and Downloading:** Share your designs directly to social media or download them in various formats (JPG, PNG, PDF) depending on your plan.

2) Solved Lab Activities

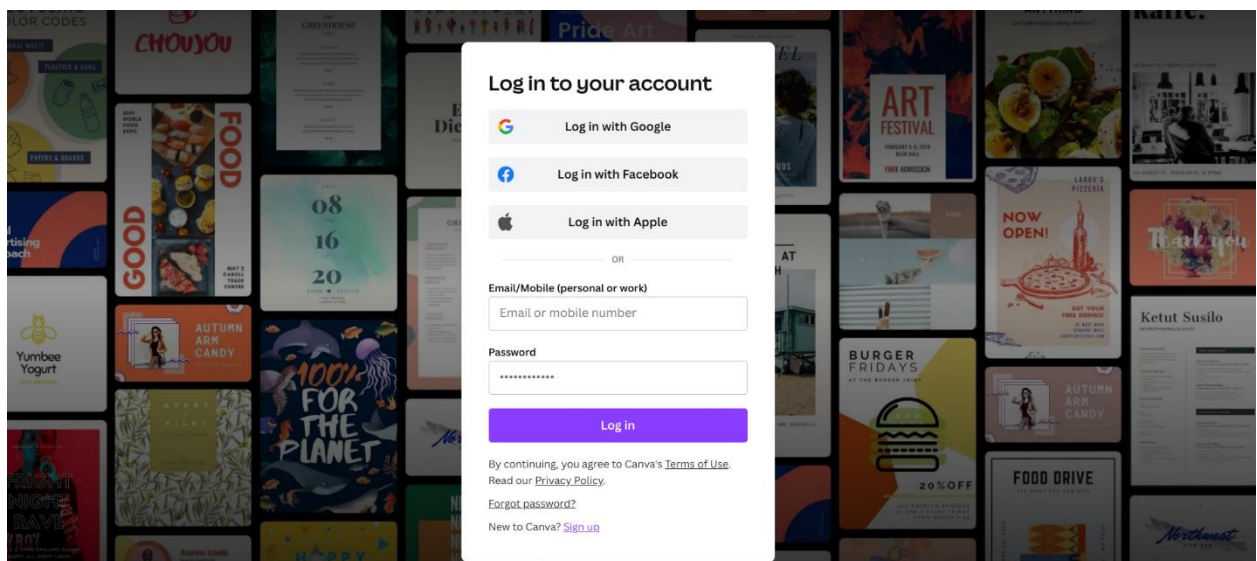
<i>Sr.No</i>	<i>Allocated Time</i>	<i>Level of Complexity</i>	<i>CLO Mapping</i>
<i>1</i>	<i>10min</i>	<i>Low</i>	<i>CLO5</i>
<i>2</i>	<i>30min</i>	<i>Medium</i>	<i>CLO5</i>
<i>3</i>	<i>30min</i>	<i>Medium</i>	<i>CLO5</i>
<i>4</i>	<i>30min</i>	<i>Medium</i>	<i>CLO5</i>

Activity 1: Getting started with Canva

Solution:

Navigate the Canva interface

To create a new social media asset in Canva, you'll need to **log in** or **create a new account**. To begin, navigate to [Canva.com](https://www.canva.com) and complete one of those steps. You will be directed to provide your email address and create a password, or log in via your Google, Facebook, or Apple account.



You can also choose to download Canva desktop app if you **prefer to work offline or want potentially smoother performance for editing complex designs.**

Activity 2: Create a design

Solution:

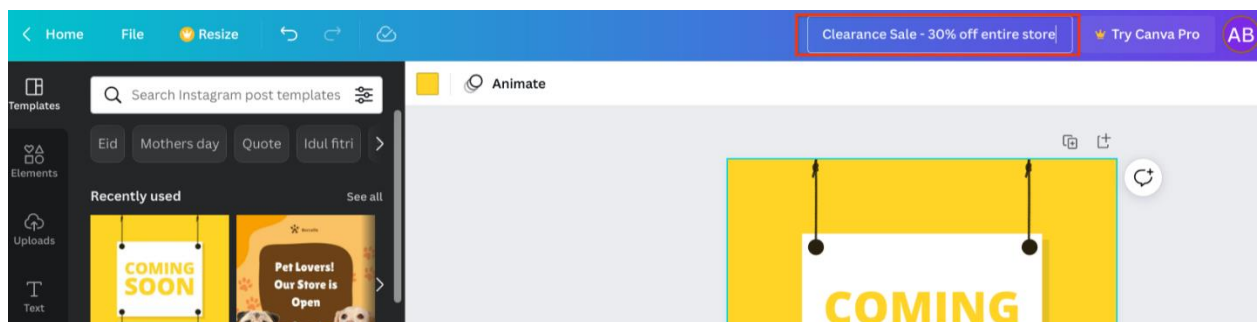
Select **create a design**. Select the type of post you want to create. You'll have the option to create a video, presentation, Instagram post or story, poster, Facebook post, logo, flyer, infographic, resume, and other types of content. For now for an example, select an **Instagram post**.

Design tip: Sketching a rough outline of your design on paper before you begin can help you bring your vision to life. It doesn't need to be perfect. Consider what you'd like to include in the design, and where it might look best.

1. Choose the right dimensions for your design

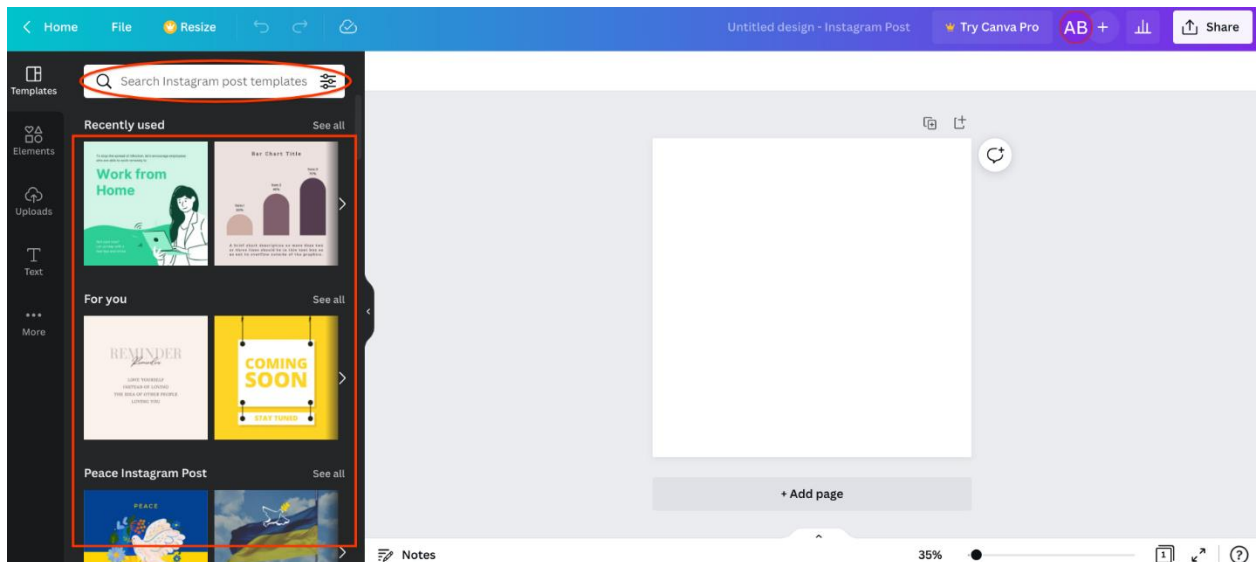
To begin, choose your design type from the Canva homepage. These are set to the optimal dimensions for each graphic, whether it's a social media post, flyer or more. Or you can use custom dimensions by searching for "custom size". You can choose from pixels, millimetres or inches.

Now, title your post in the bar at the top of the page. Make sure to give your post a descriptive title. For example, your title might include the name of the discount being offered or an upcoming holiday.



Browse Canva's various templates by entering keywords in the search bar that involves the specific topic of your post or business, like **electronic store**, or more vague terms, such as **colorful**.

***Note:** The free templates do not have a crown icon. The items with a crown require a paid Canva Pro account.*



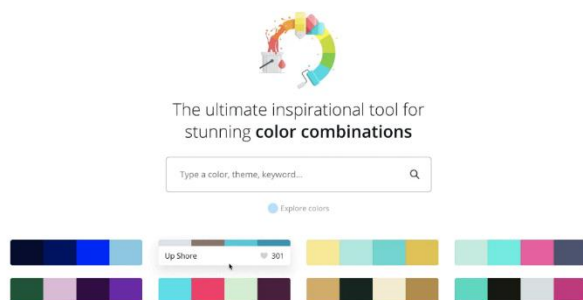
When you find a template you like, select it to add to your post. You can adjust and edit all the elements within the template by selecting an element. A toolbar will pop up, allowing you to make any changes you want. You'll have the ability to change colors, sizes, fonts, text alignment, spacing, and more. If you want to select more than one element, you can click and drag your mouse over the elements you wish to edit, and they'll be selected together.

2. Choose a background

The background for your design could be a color or an image.

Background colors

Design tip: Different colors tell different stories. Purple is associated with individuality, orange relates to activity, and green conjures images of nature. Think about what colors best suit your needs. Find a good color combination with the [color palette tool](#).



Of course, you can always use a white background too. To choose a color, use the Color Picker tool in the toolbar at the top of the editor.

Background photos

To use a photo as a background, first add a grid. Once placed on a grid, photos can be resized, cropped, [flipped](#) and layered to create a variety of visual effects.

Next, search Images or upload your own. Then drag and drop your image onto the grid: it will snap to fit.

You can [add filters](#) to change the brightness, saturation and clarity of the photo. This can help when [layering text](#) and elements.

Design tip: You can add background images or feature images to your design.

A *background image* supports the message of the content. If there's too much going on in the background, it's hard to overlay things like text or illustrations. When you are choosing a background image for your design, consider texture over structure. You can [crop images](#) to find pockets of texture that will work better—this way you can also remove any space or features in the image that creates too much noise.

The image below uses a close up photograph of a rose to add textural interest to the design, but its main role is to act as a vehicle for the text.



A *feature image* becomes the focus of your design: this image sits high in the order of [visual hierarchy](#). Use a single, or split-cell grid to apply clever feature images and help your content sing. The image below uses a grid to balance the visual hierarchy of the design. The user's eye is drawn to the photograph.



3. Add your elements

Your design might include text, icons, photos or illustrations. These need to be combined in a way that is visually appealing. Canva graphic designer Lynneal Santos says it's a matter of balance.

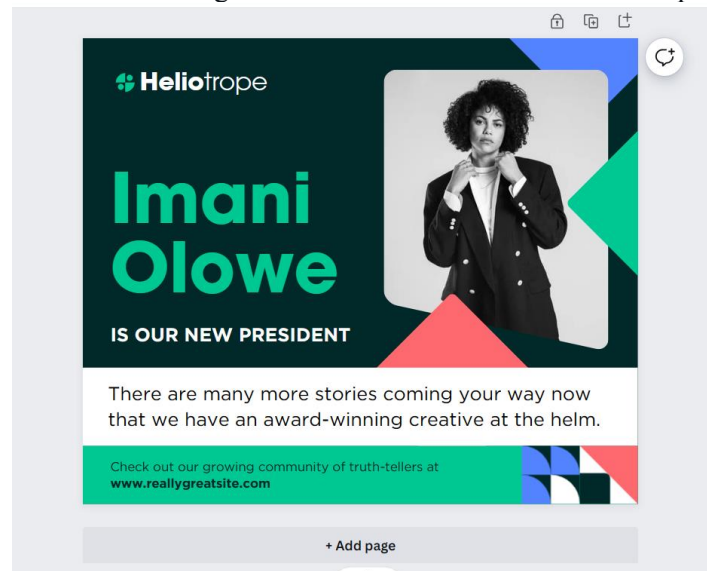
"Consider the balance and composition of all the elements in the design. When you're laying out your elements, ask are the elements balanced? Are they centered? And ensure they're not too close to other elements or the edge of the page."

"Keep it simple." Don't overload your design with too many elements, as it can confuse the visual message of the image. This is something designers call [visual heirarchy](#), which involves the

arrangement of elements according to their importance. Try playing with size, color, and placement in order to see what works best.

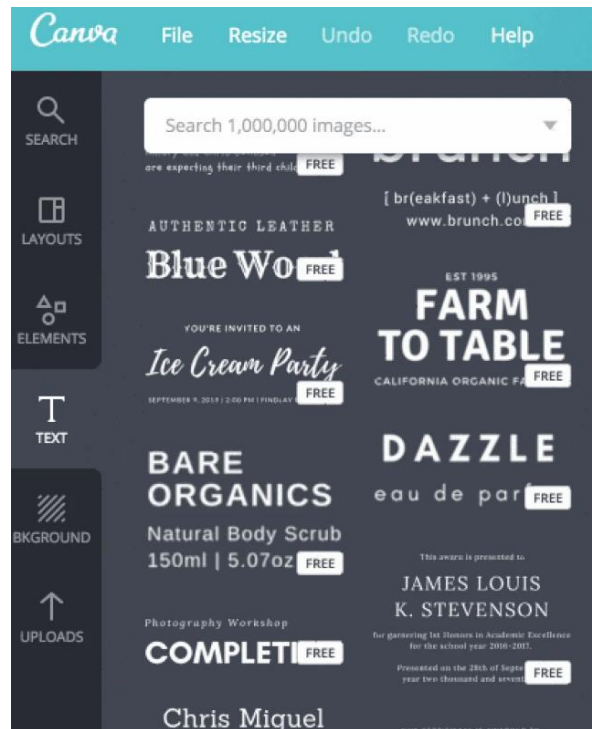
If you want to add a photo to your design, try using one of Canva's frames. You can find these under "elements" in the side panel.

Design Tip: Harness the power of negative space. Negative space, also known as white space can be any area within a design that is free from text, images, or embellishments (it doesn't have to actually be white). Designers love it because it can help create grouping, add emphasis and improve legibility. Take some time to understand the design elements involved in a social media post below.

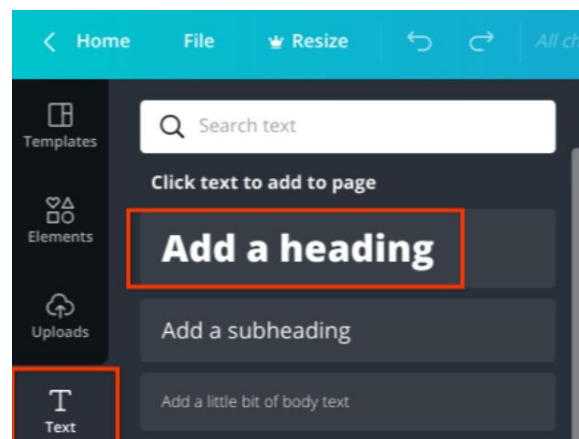


4. Choose the right fonts

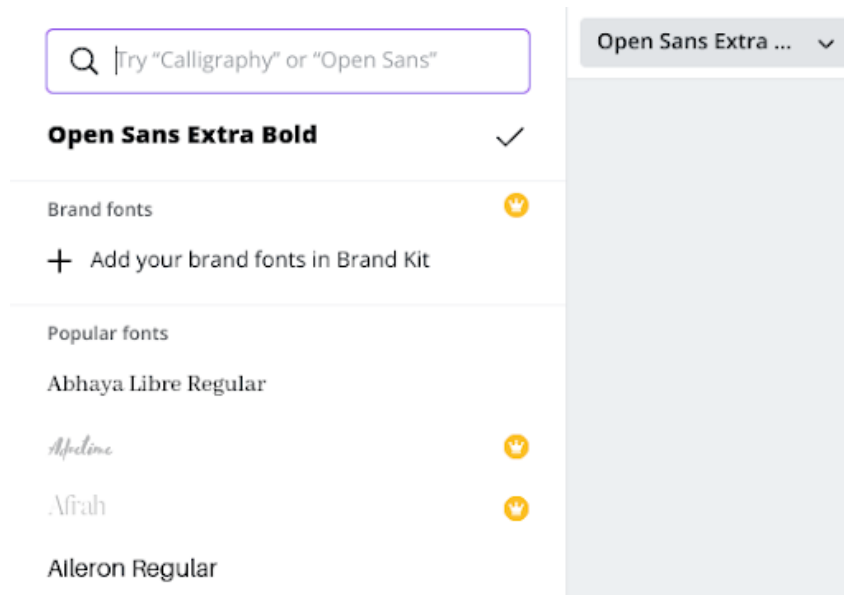
The look of your fonts can have a huge impact on your design. Choosing one font is hard enough. But your design may need more than one typeface. Canva suggests never using more than two fonts in a design, as too many fonts tends to make a design look "messy". You'll want to choose complementary fonts, which add visual interest while working well together. You can learn more about which fonts look good together with [tips on font pairing.](#) Canva has hundreds of pre-set font combinations to choose from. You can find these in the Text tab in the side panel.



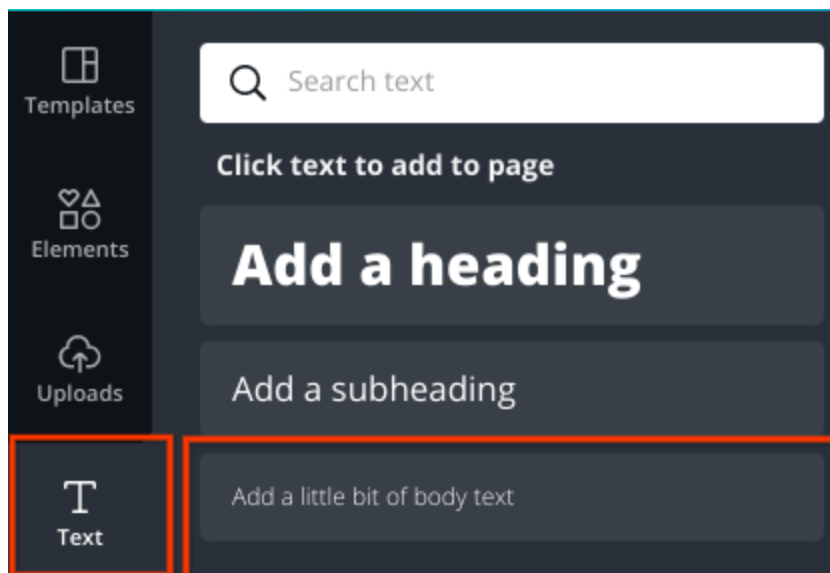
Or you can create your own combination. Again, simple is best: if you're choosing an elaborate font, ensure you pair it with a simpler font so your design is balanced. Canva's [Font Combination](#) tool can help, and Traditional combinations like a sans serif font and a serif font can be very powerful. Don't forget about readability. If your fonts are too complicated, they can detract from your message.



To adjust text, select the text you want to edit and **choose a font from the dropdown menu**. To ensure your text is accessible, avoid complicated fonts and italics, bold, or other special lettering.



If you need to add additional body text, go to the **Text** menu and select **Add a little bit of body text**. Move the text box to where you would like to place it in the post.



Design tip: Typographic hierarchy establishes the order of importance given to different design elements. By applying different fonts, color and scale to your text, you can dramatically change the way your message is received.

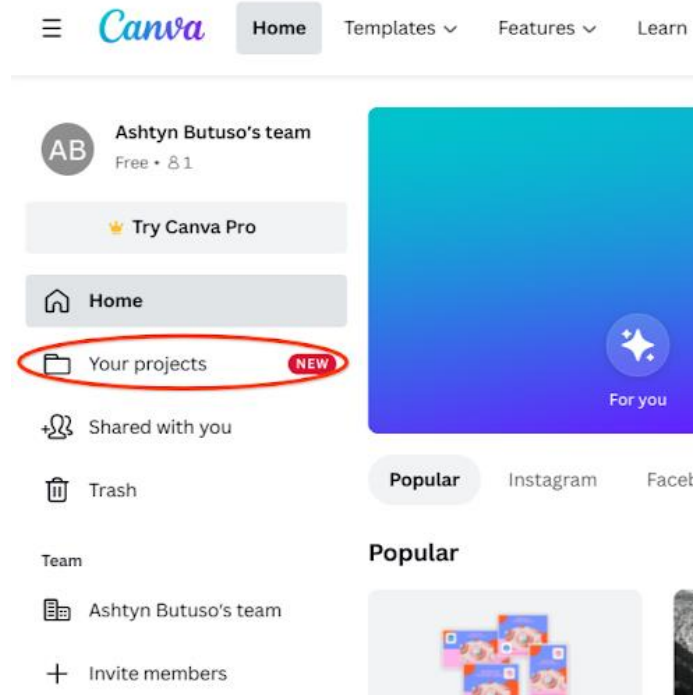


Next, click on the **Elements tab** to find graphics, photos, videos, and more. **Type a keyword** in the search bar to find relevant elements for your design. When you click on an item in the elements tab, it will automatically be added to your canvas, but feel free to drag it around and place it where you want.

5. Save and share your work

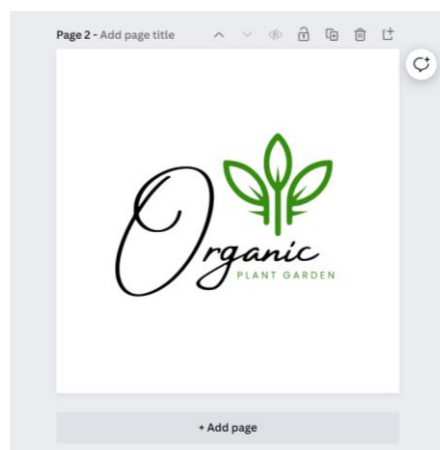
You might want to share your post with collaborators before posting your new post on social media. To share, click the share button. Here you can set the sharing permissions from **only people added** to **Anyone with the link**. You can also choose what access to allow, from full editing access to view only. You can either click **Copy link** or add in your collaborators email addresses.

Finally, be sure to **save the work** you did to complete this activity. Canva automatically saves your work, but you can also save it by clicking **File** and selecting **Save**. After you save your work, navigate to the homepage to the **Your Projects** tab, where you can find your saved projects.



Activity 3:

Create a logo for your brand



Solution:

1. Open Canva and Choose a Starting Point:

- Search for "Logo" in the search bar. You'll see two options:
 - **Logo Maker:** This offers a user-friendly interface with pre-designed templates. Great for beginners!
 - **Blank Design:** This gives you complete creative freedom to create a logo from scratch.

2. Using Logo Templates:

- Browse through the various logo templates offered by Canva. There are options for different industries, styles (minimalist, playful, etc.), and color schemes.

- Choose a template that resonates with your brand image.

3. Customizing Your Logo:

- Once you have a template, you can customize it completely using the drag-and-drop interface. Here's what you can edit:
 - **Text:** Change the name, tagline, or any text element in the template. Choose fonts that reflect your brand personality.
 - **Graphics:** Replace the icons or illustrations in the template with ones that better represent your brand. You can upload your own graphics or choose from Canva's extensive library.
 - **Colors:** Edit the colors of the template to match your brand color palette.

4. Using a Blank Design (For More Experienced Users):

- Choose the "Blank Design" option if you want complete creative control.
- Upload your own icons, illustrations, or photos to use in your logo.
- Use Canva's shapes and lines tools to create your own design elements.
- Experiment with different layouts and text arrangements.

5. Refine and Download:

- Once you're happy with your logo design, ensure it's visually balanced and easy to read at various sizes.
- Download your logo in a high-resolution format (e.g., PNG) with a transparent background.

Here are some additional tips for designing a logo in Canva:

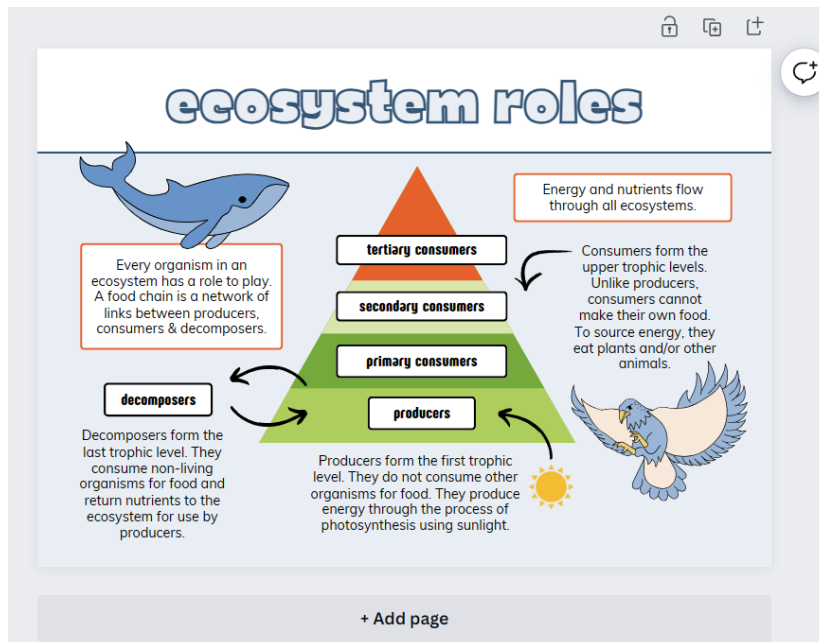
- **Keep it simple:** A logo should be memorable and easy to understand.
- **Consider your target audience:** What kind of image do you want to project?
- **Use high-quality visuals:** Blurry or pixelated graphics will give a negative impression.
- **Test your logo at different sizes:** Make sure it looks good on social media profiles, business cards, and other marketing materials.

Activity 4:

Design an infographic using Canva

Solution:

Pick a complex topic (e.g., the water cycle, photosynthesis) and present it in a visually appealing infographic using Canva's charts and icons.



1. Start with a Design:

- In the search bar, type "Infographics" to open the dedicated section.

2. Choose a Template (Optional):

- Canva offers a vast library of infographic templates for various purposes (e.g., business, education, social media).
- Browse the options and pick a template that best suits your infographic's theme and style.
- You can filter the templates by category, color, or layout for easier searching.

3. Go Blank for Full Control:

- If you prefer a completely custom design, choose "Blank design" to start with a fresh canvas.
- This option allows maximum creative freedom for your infographic.

4. Customize Your Infographic:

- Once you have a template or a blank canvas, it's time to personalize it!
- Here's what you can edit using Canva's drag-and-drop interface:
 - **Text:** Change headings, body text, or add data points. Choose fonts that complement your brand or the infographic's theme.
 - **Graphics:** Replace placeholder images, icons, or illustrations with ones that visually represent your information. You can upload your own visuals or use elements from Canva's library (free and paid options available).
 - **Background:** Select a background color or image that complements your overall design and ensures readability.
 - **Charts & Graphs:** If your infographic involves data visualization, Canva offers a variety of chart and graph templates you can customize with your data.

5. Refine and Download:

- Once you're happy with the visual elements, ensure the information is clear, concise, and easy to follow.

- Maintain a consistent visual style throughout the infographic for a professional look.
- Proofread all text for any errors before downloading.
- Canva allows you to download your infographic in various formats like PNG, JPG, or PDF. Choose the format that best suits your needs (e.g., PNG for transparent background for social media).

Bonus Tips:

- **Keep it concise:** Focus on the most important information and avoid overloading the infographic with text.
- **Visual hierarchy:** Use size, color, and placement to guide the viewer's eye through the information.
- **Brand alignment:** Ensure the infographic's colors, fonts, and overall style reflect your brand identity.

3) Graded Lab Tasks

Note: The instructor can design graded lab activities according to the level of difficulty and complexity of the solved lab activities. The lab tasks assigned by the instructor should be evaluated in the same lab

Lab Task 1

Design a poster as shown in the figure below.



Lab Task 2

Design a social media campaign for your online business consisting of 3-5 social media posts (Instagram/Facebook) promoting a specific product or service. The designs should be visually appealing, consistent with your brand identity, and target your ideal customer.

Example social media campaign:

Campaign: "Rescue Day" at the Animal Shelter (Instagram)

Post 1 (Image): A carousel post featuring adorable photos (or a short video) of different animals up for adoption at the shelter.

Caption: Calling all animal lovers! It's #RescueDay at [Shelter Name] and these cuties are looking for their forever homes. Every adoption saves a life - come meet your perfect match this Saturday! #AdoptDontShop #FindYourFriend

Post 2 (Story): A series of Instagram story slides throughout the day of "Rescue Day".

Slide 1 (Image): Photo of volunteers playing with the animals. **Caption:** The fun is already underway at [Shelter Name]'s #RescueDay! Come join us, play with some adorable animals, and maybe even find your new best friend!

Slide 2 (Video): Short video clip highlighting a success story - a recent adoption. **Caption:** Look at this happy pair! This is why we do what we do. #RescueDay is all about making these connections.

Slide 3 (Interactive): Poll with the question "What kind of animal are you thinking of adopting?" with options like "Dog", "Cat", "Other".

Post 3 (Image): A photo collage of happy new pet owners with their adopted animals.

Caption: What a heartwarming #RescueDay! So many amazing animals found their loving homes today. Thank you to everyone who came out and made a difference! #AdoptDontShop #FindYourFriend